

Chapter 136-5

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Because Liang Shi was a party to the case, and had been unconscious the whole time.

During these days, it was Su Zhe and Liang Xinzhou who had been handling these matters. The person in charge of the case at the Municipal Public Security Bureau, upon learning that she had woken up, received word from above not to disturb her rest.

Instead, they waited until she had fully rested and came to them on her own initiative.

The incident from that day still needed her statement and testimony.

Chen Liuying had really kicked an iron plate this time.¹ Both Liang Xinzhou and Su Zhe were determined to send her in, even pushing toward the death penalty.

It was just that her level of crime was far from reaching the death penalty—at most, it would be life imprisonment.

Chen Liuying had already been detained for a long time, yet not a single relative had come to visit her, nor had any lawyer come to defend her.

She herself seemed to have given up too, lying inside sleeping all day.

Liang Shi first went to supplement her testimony and statement, then heard the police officer nearby say that the bureau was taking this case very seriously, so she should be able to get the outcome Liang Shi wanted.

At that moment, Liang Shi also thought about how the bureau chief here was a relative of Zhao Xuning.

So Zhao Xuning must have also contributed to this.

Liang Shi sent Zhao Xuning a message: 【Thanks.】

Zhao Xuning: 【...What are you going crazy about?】

Liang Shi:

"You have recalled a message."

Liang Shi felt that one should never get sentimental with a straight-laced queen.²

Upon hearing that Liang Shi wanted to see Chen Liuying, the police didn't stop her, only requesting that the entire meeting be recorded on video.

Liang Shi thought about it and nodded.

There wasn't much content that couldn't be heard anyway. What Liang Shi wanted to ask were just the same old things.

Seeing Chen Liuying again after just over half a month, she already looked nothing like she did in memory.

Chen Liuying was originally thin in order to look good on camera, though she had previously worked out and built a fit physique. These days, she probably hadn't been exercising anymore, her spirit dejected.

Without those expensive skincare products and toiletries here, her hair was dry like straw, and her face had broken out in acne.

Especially her forehead, which had a large patch of red spots.

Liang Shi casually looked her over a few times, then asked after a moment: "Why did you kidnap Xu Qingzhu that day?"

"Tired of hearing that." Chen Liuying said lazily.

At this point, Chen Liuying had long since given up on herself completely. During so many days of interrogation, she had confessed everything she could confess.

Now that Liang Shi came to ask, she couldn't be bothered to answer: "Ask something else."

Liang Shi paused.

After a while, Liang Shi asked again: "Were you acting under someone's orders?"

Chen Liuying was wearing handcuffs, and the slightest movement produced the sound of metal clashing. She laughed in a roguish manner: "Tired of hearing that too. Try another one."

Liang Shi: "....."

Chen Liuying was being very uncooperative, which was within Liang Shi's expectations.

But what Liang Shi most wanted to ask was—

"Was it a spur-of-the-moment decision or premeditated?"

Chen Liuying raised her eyebrow: "Does it make a difference?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Yes."

Chen Liuying thought about it, took the finger she had been using to pick her ear, brought it in front of her face and blew on it. Her whole demeanor seemed wicked.

The corner of her lips curved up slightly as she called out airily: "Liang Shi."

Liang Shi responded: "Hm?"

"Back when you were stealing my spotlight on set, when you were deliberately stealing my scenes, why didn't you ask yourself..." A flash of resentment passed through Chen Liuying's eyes, "...whether it was a spur-of-the-moment decision or premeditated?"

"So you simply hate me?" Liang Shi wasn't provoked by her words and asked back very calmly.

Chen Liuying scoffed lightly: "No."

Liang Shi frowned: "Then what else?"

Chen Liuying's tongue pressed against her teeth as she looked at Liang Shi coldly. After a long while, she finally said: "I really like Xu Qingzhu too."

"A woman like that." Chen Liuying said: "Who wouldn't want to have her? She's smart, capable, and beautiful. It's just a bit annoying that I fell at her hands. But..."

"Then why did you still hurt her?" Liang Shi seized the opportunity to ask: "You clearly knew she has PTSD."

Chen Liuying was stunned.

Her daze lasted for a long time, as if she couldn't answer Liang Shi's question.

The air was so quiet it seemed about to freeze.

Suddenly, Chen Liuying spoke, asking in bewilderment: "Yeah? Why?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Chen Liuying said: "It seems like the thought just appeared in my head—so I did it."

Footnotes:

¹ "踢到鐵板" (kicked an iron plate) - A Chinese idiom meaning to run into an immovable obstacle or to mess with the wrong person; similar to "kicking a hornet's nest" or "biting off more than one can chew."

² "直女逼王" - A slang term that roughly translates to a woman who appears very cool, aloof, and unemotional on the surface (often appearing "straight-laced" or serious), but this is just their natural demeanor. The term is often used affectionately to describe someone who isn't good at expressing emotions or being sentimental.